RICOCHET
ASSOCIATION TRANSFORMATION

How does my association evolve from a traditional brand guide to an AI design system?

A brand guide AI can read

A traditional brand guide is a PDF written for people. An AI design system holds the same brand as plain-text rules, exact values and labeled examples that AI tools can read, so the drafts your staff get from AI start on brand instead of being fixed after.

FROM TRADITIONAL BRAND GUIDE TO AI DESIGN SYSTEM

Traditional brand guide	
Who reads it	People
Format	A PDF or slide deck
What it holds	Mostly logo and color rules
How pieces combine	Left to judgment
Updates	Reissued now and then
What staff get	A rulebook to look up

EVOLVES INTO

AI design system	
Who reads it	People and AI tools
Format	Plain-text files with exact values
What it holds	Adds voice, words and templates
How pieces combine	Written as rules
Updates	One live source everyone pulls from
What staff get	Drafts that start closer to brand

WHAT MAKES IT AI-READY

Plain text
Simple text files (Markdown) any staff member can edit, plus a structured file for colors and type.

Exact values
Color codes and font names, never "a navy blue."

Rules with reasons
When to use each element, and when not to.

Labeled examples
Right and wrong versions side by side, so the AI copies the right one.

One owner
A named staff owner who keeps a version date and change log.

REFRESH AN OLD ASSET IN SIX STEPS

1 Open
Load last year's email into your AI tool with the design system attached.

2 Restructure
Ask it to apply information architecture best practices.

3 Rewrite
Ask it to apply copywriting best practices and your voice.

4 Restyle
Ask it to apply your design system: layout, colors, type.

5 Review
A person checks facts, dues, dates and legal terms.

6 Load
Move the new asset into your email delivery platform.

WORKS WITH THE AI YOUR STAFF ALREADY USE

Claude
Add it to a Project, or package it as a Skill.

ChatGPT
Add it to a Project or a custom GPT.

Copilot
Add it as knowledge in a Copilot agent.

Gemini
Attach it as files in a Gem.

Grok
Add it to a Project.

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ANATOMY OF AN AI DESIGN SYSTEM

1 Logo lockup
The primary logo and tagline as one approved unit.

2 Logo variations
Stacked, horizontal, mark-only, reversed and one-color versions, and when to use each.

3 Clear space and minimum size
How much room the logo needs and how small it can go.

4 Color tokens
Exact color values, each with a name and a job, such as charcoal for headlines.

5 Type scale
Fonts, sizes, weights and spacing for each level, from headline to caption.

6 Voice and tone
How you sound, with sample lines that sound right and wrong.

7 Word list
Preferred terms, program names, member categories and words to avoid.

AMERICAN WIDGET SOCIETY

VARIATIONS



IMAGERY



CLEAR SPACE

x x min 24 px

COMPONENTS

Renew now — 90 DAYS TO RENEWAL

COLOR TOKENS

Charcoal	Green	Blue	Light	Alert
#2C3E5C	#27AE60	#4A6A8C	#ECF0F1	#C0392B

TEMPLATES



TYPE SCALE

Headline
Montserrat 800

Welcome, you're in.
Dancing Script

Body text
IBM Plex Sans

ACCESSIBILITY

Charcoal on Light 9.6:1 ✓	Green text on white 2.9:1 ×

VOICE AND TONE

✓ Your renewal keeps widget standards moving.
~~Don't miss out!!! Renew NOW~~

CO-BRANDING

AWS | OHIO CHAPTER

WORD LIST

✓	×
✓ member	× customer
✓ Annual Conference	× AWS con

DON'TS — Stretched or recolored

8 Imagery and icons
Photo style and an approved icon set.

9 Components
Reusable pieces such as email headers, event banners, buttons and stat callouts.

10 Templates
Starting files for email, social posts, slides, sponsor decks and certificates.

11 Accessibility
Contrast-safe color pairs, minimum type sizes, alt text rules and link styles.

12 Co-branding
What chapters, sponsors, partners and volunteers may adapt, and what they may not.

13 Don'ts
Real examples of misuse.

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BEFORE AND AFTER: ONE RENEWAL EMAIL

Having trouble viewing this email? Click here to view it in your web browser.

AMERICAN WIDGET SOCIETY
~ Membership Department ~

***** IMPORTANT RENEWAL NOTICE *****

Dear Member,

This is a reminder that your membership in the American Widget Society will **EXPIRE SOON**. Please renew at your earliest convenience to continue to receive all of the benefits of membership including publications, discounts, events, networking opportunities, education and much more!!

As a member you are part of a community of professionals dedicated to the advancement of the widget industry. Your membership supports our advocacy efforts, our standards work, our annual conference and our many educational programs throughout the year.

To renew, please visit our website and log in to your account, then click on My Account, then Renew Membership, and follow the instructions provided. Forgot your password? Click here. Questions? Call the membership department during regular business hours.

CLICK HERE TO RENEW NOW!!!

Thank you for your continued support.
The Membership Department

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- Structure
- Rewrite
- Restyle
- Review



Jordan, your renewal is coming up

Your membership renews in 90 days. Here is what stays with you when you renew.

STANDARDS
Early access to every new widget standard.

NETWORK
4,000 peers and your Ohio chapter.

SAVINGS
Member pricing at the Annual Conference.

Renew in one click

Questions? Reply to this email and a real person will answer.

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RICOCHET
ASSOCIATION TRANSFORMATION

Why work with Ricochet?

Deep bench
Specialists in marketing, membership, project management, data, systems integration and AI.

Fluent in your stack
Hands-on with the marketing automation, AMS and AI platforms associations use, so we fit each to your goals.

Been in your seat
We have worked on association staff and consulted with dozens of associations. Many of us hold industry credentials.

For 10 years, Ricochet has worked only with professional and trade associations on marketing, communications, technology and data. Chief Consultant Chris Gloede, CAE, was the first Chief Marketing Officer of the American Bar Association.

Meet with us

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